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China Auto Manufacturers

CPCA May Update; Export Strong, NEV Wholesale In Line

CITI'S TAKE

According to CPCA, May-26 **NEV-PV wholesales** came in-line at 1.35mn units (+10.6% YoY/+10.3% MoM), with NEV-PV retail at 950k units (-7.5% YoY/+12.4% MoM). **PV exports** remained strong at 784k units (+75.1% YoY/+2.3% MoM) in May-26, with NEV-PV export volume at 424k units in May-26 (+112.6% YoY/+4.4% MoM). NEV export mix increased by +9ppt YoY/+1.3ppt MoM to 54.0% in May. 5M26 PV export was +69% YoY to 3.38mn units, with 5M26 NEV export +117% YoY to 1.73mn units. CPCA estimates **PV sector inventory destocking** at around 82k units in May-26, with 5M26 sector destocking of 350k units (vs restocking of 10k units in 5M25). **Further reading:** [China Auto Manufacturers – Weekly EV Orders Update; June Trading Range Prediction](#)

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May-26 sales overview:

(1) May-26 CPCA PV **Production**: 2.21mn units (-3.1% YoY/+0.7% MoM), within which luxury brand production was -9% YoY and +2% MoM.

(2) May-26 CPCA PV **Wholesale**: 2.21mn units (-4.6% YoY/+4.8% MoM). We estimate PV destocking around 82k units MoM in May, derived from wholesales volume of 2.21mn minus the sum of retail volume (1.51mn) and export volume (784k).

(3) May-26 CPCA PV **Retail** sales: 1.51mn units (-22.1% YoY/+9.2% MoM).

(4) May-26 CPCA **ICE PV performance**: May-26 wholesale registered 860k units, -21% YoY/-2% MoM; May-26 retail sales volume at 560k units, -39% YoY/+5% MoM.

(5) May-26 CPCA **luxury sales**: Retail sales came in at 160k units, -20% YoY/+13% MoM.

(6) **NEV PV wholesale**: May-26 NEV PV wholesale logged 1.35mn units, +10.6% YoY/+10.3% MoM. 5M26 NEV PV wholesale reached 5.31mn units (+1.7% YoY). Total May-26 NEV penetration reached 61.1%, +8ppt YoY/+3ppt MoM. May-26 BEV PV wholesale came in at 886k units, +16.6% YoY/+13.9% MoM; PHEV PV (excl. EREV) at 372k units, +10.5% YoY/+2.9% MoM; EREV PV at 95k units, -24.9% YoY/+8.9% MoM. May-26 B-segment BEV wholesale volume was +42% YoY/+9% MoM, and A00 class BEV sales volume was -44% YoY/+22% MoM.

(7) **May-26 Tesla sales**: Domestic wholesale reached 85,982 units (Model Y: 54,765, Model 3: 31,217), +39% YoY/+8% MoM, of which Tesla's export volume accounted for 38,701 units (+68% YoY/-28% MoM), suggesting May-26 domestic retail sales (excl. exports) to be around 47.3k units (+21% YoY/+80% MoM).

(8) Per **CPCA-Retail sales** benchmark, May-26 NEV-PV retail reached 950k units (-7.5% YoY/+12.4% MoM). 5M26 NEV PV retail reached 3.70mn units (-15.1% YoY). Retail penetration was at 62.9% in May-26 (+9.9ppts YoY/+1.6ppts MoM).

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(9) **May-26 Export PV:** PV export registered 784k units (+75.1% YoY/+2.3% MoM) in May-26, with 5M26 PV export +69% YoY to 3.38mn units. Total NEV-PV export volume logged 424k units in May-26 (+112.6% YoY/+4.4% MoM), with 5M26 NEV export +117.3% YoY to 1.73mn units. NEV export mix increased by +9ppt YoY/+1.3ppt MoM to 54.0% in May.

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